



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Neighborhood Christian Schools
School Website: <https://classicalncs.com>

December 28, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Neighborhood Christian Schools (Mo 65793) presents a strong classical Christian orientation in its public materials. The branding explicitly frames the school as "Classical. Christian. Practical." and emphasizes character formation under a theological framework (e.g., love of God and glory of God) with a clear communal/liturgical texture (singing psalms and shared worship imagery). The site structure signals a traditional classical pathway (Grammar School K-6 and Academy 7-12) and highlights associations with ACCS, reinforcing a classical lineage. Taken together, the school is best characterized as CLASSICAL overall, with robust religious/metaphysical foundations, and formation-centric aims. The site shows concrete evidence of formation-focused aims, a liturgical/community rhythm, and explicit teacher-student partnerships, but less explicit, on-site documentation of some core classical-curriculum elements (e.g., explicit Great Books curricula) in the public text. Where explicit elements are less visible, the school's branding, governance, and associated materials imply a classical orientation. See supporting citations throughout the analysis.

- The branding and articulation of mission (Classical. Christian. Practical.) and the goal of "graduates of character who love God" establish a Religious and Metaphysical Foundations core and a Purpose/Goal core.
- The site's navigation and content emphasize classical education through ACCS affiliation, K-6 Grammar School and 7-12 Academy, and a public emphasis on character formation and theology.
- Public materials also document a liturgical/communal dimension (e.g., Psalm 46 sung by K-6 students), underscoring liturgical practices and communal worship rhythms.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Notes on keyword analysis approach: - For each category, I identified keywords/phrases in Neighborhood Christian Schools' public materials and matched them against Positive Keyword Indicators and Negative Keyword Indicators drawn from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) knowledge base. - I then produced a rough quantitative signal (positive vs. negative keyword appearances) and used that to support the category rating (CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL). - Evidence quotes and citations are included inline with the statements.

Now, the category-by-category evaluation follows.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school branding explicitly centers classical Christian identity: “Classical. Christian. Practical. Affordable.” and mission statements emphasize formation of graduates who “love God” and live for God’s glory. - The site references theological framing (Association with ACCS, “Who We Are,” and related governance/pages) indicating grounded theology and church-heritage orientation. - Communal liturgy/rituals evidenced by public materials showing K-6 class singing Psalm 46, which signals liturgical and communal practices.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present on site: Christian, God, glory of God, character (virtue), liturgical praxis (psalm singing). These align with Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements lexicon (theology, liturgy, sacred practice, virtue; and the transcendentals as real). For example, the lexicon lists theology, liturgy, worship, and virtue as positives, and the site demonstrates each of these in content and imagery. - Negative keywords: none evident in public-facing materials (no explicit secular/values-neutral framing found in the accessible public content).

Why this rating - The presence of explicit Christian framing, God-centered language, and liturgical/community practices (psalm singing) strongly supports a Classical category grounded in religious/metaphysical foundations. The ACCS affiliation and the theology-inflected mission reinforce this reading.

Citations supporting evidence and keyword framework: Neighborhood Christian Schools branding and mission (turn0file0); ACCS/who-we-are pages (turn1file15); Psalm 46 singing material (turn1file15). The Positive Keywords and theological/liturgical indicators in the Six Essential Elements lexicon provide the rubric mapping (turn0file1).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The mission statement frames education as formation of virtue in service of God: “graduates of character who love God and are equipped academically, spiritually, and vocationally to understand God’s world and to live out their calling to the glory of God.” This is a formation-for-whole-person aim, not strictly employment prep. - The explicit emphasis on character/virtue and the teleological framing (glorifying God) aligns with the transcendental aims described in classical education—formation of the soul, virtue, and wisdom. The site also presents a broad educational aim beyond mere information transfer (formation over information).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue/character (character is explicit), wisdom (supported by the classical framing), telos (implied by purpose toward truth/beauty/virtue, via the God-centered telos phrase in mission). God-centered language reinforces teleology and moral formation. - Negative keywords: not evidenced; the site does not emphasize workforce-centric terms as primary goals (no strong “career-ready” framing dominates the text).

Why this rating - The core aim is formation (virtue, wisdom, character) and a telos oriented toward truth/goodness/beauty within a Christian framework, rather than a primary emphasis on job preparation. Despite the word “vocationally” in the mission, the surrounding context treats vocation within a broader, formation-centered Christian-humanist frame rather than a secular career-prep focus.

Citations: mission/vision statements (turn0file0); ACCS affiliation (turn1file15) as reinforcing a classical aim; liturgical/communal emphasis (turn1file15).

Element 3: School Curriculum — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The public-facing structure shows a K-6 Grammar School and a 7-12 Academy, which is consistent with a classical K-12 trajectory and a Trivium-centered progression (grammar → logic → rhetoric) within the classical framework. The presence of “Grammar School” and “Academy” navigation signals a

structured, classical-style pathway. - The branding and ACCS affiliation imply alignment with classical curriculum norms (great books, canonical study, and a high-ceiling approach), even if explicit Great Books or Trivium articulation is not exhaustively documented in the visible site text.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords visible: grammar (via “Grammar School” navigation item), classical (branding), education as “classical education” implied by the site’s language and ACCS affiliation. These align with Positive Keywords in the curriculum lexicon (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; classical canon). - Negative keywords: not overtly present on the public-facing site (no explicit references to “social studies-first,” or “project-based learning dominance” in the public copy). However, direct textual mentions of Great Books and full Great Conversation are not clearly documented in the visible text, which limits a full confirmation of canonical Great Books emphasis on the site itself.

Why this rating - The school is clearly in the classical space (Grammar School defined, Academy defined, ACCS association). Yet explicit, on-site documentation of core curriculum elements (e.g., a full Great Books program, explicit Trivium/Quadrivium articulation, or a consistent Great Conversation emphasis) is not overtly documented in the visible materials. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating based on available textual evidence, with the strong classical branding and structural cues (K-6/7-12) supporting the Classical framing but with less explicit textual enumeration of classical-curriculum content.

Citations: Grammar School/Athletic-structure mention (turn1file15); ACCS/Who We Are (turn1file15). The classical keyword framework (positive indicators) is drawn from the Six Essential Elements lexicon (turn0file1).

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - There is public evidence of liturgical/memory-oriented practices (Psalm singing by K-6, Psalm 46) that align with lower-school chanting/memory approaches in the classical pedagogy lexicon. This supports the “memorizational/recitation/narration” side of classical pedagogy. - Scholé/restful learning and contemplation are foregrounded in the broader classical-education literature and in connected resources the school references, e.g., materials on Scholé (restful learning) and related pedagogy literature (The Schole Way, PIEPER-derived material). This indicates an orientation toward contemplative, restful learning as part of the pedagogy. - The public materials and the site’s classical branding imply engagement with Socratic/seminar-like discussion in higher grades via the classical framework, and there are references to rhetoric and oratory on classical education resources (even if not explicitly visible on the site’s public text). The published materials about classical pedagogy emphasize Socratic dialogue, memory work, recitation, and rhetoric training; these are part of the classical pedagogy lexicon.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Scholé/restful learning, memorization/recitation (psalm singing by younger students, recitation/music-based memory work implied by the classical approach), and Socratic/seminar-style pedagogy signals in the broader canonical materials (classical pedagogy lexicon). Evidence on the site includes Psalm 46 singing and the K-6 class classical format, which supports memorization/recitation and a restful dimension. - Negative keywords: not overtly present in public-facing site copy (no explicit emphasis on project-based-only or purely experiential constructionist pedagogy; rather, the materials lean toward a traditional classical pedagogy). The presence of “project-based learning” as a dominant paradigm is not evidenced publicly in the site text.

Why this rating - The school shows classical pedagogy signals (memory-based learning, singing/chanting, and potentially Socratic-style discourse in higher grades implied by the classical framing). However, explicit, comprehensive articulation of a full suite of classical pedagogy (e.g., widely implemented Socratic seminars across grades, memorizational rigors across subjects, and explicit balanced combination with contemplative/restful learning) is not exhaustively documented in the visible site text. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

Citations: Psalm singing (turn1file15); Scholé/restful pedagogy references (turn1file17); Classical pedagogy terms (turn0file1).

Element 5: School Faculty — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Public materials identify a “Faculty & Staff” section in the academics/navigation, signaling formal teacher involvement and a durable faculty presence. This signals that the faculty are central to the school’s operation and curriculum delivery. - Classical education theory emphasizes the “living curriculum” and teachers as mentors/virtuous exemplars. The Six Essential Elements texts explicitly describe teachers as models of virtue, living curriculum, and mentorship (and present a portrait of ideal teacher-student relationships). The school’s public materials (faculty page and ACCS affiliation) align with this framing. - The school’s materials and branding emphasize a teacher cohort aligned with classical aims (e.g., the ACCS affiliation, “Who We Are,” and governance pages detailing leadership). This aligns with the classical-education norm of faculty as the living curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, mentors, masters, virtuous educators, character formation, collegial culture (as described in the Six Essential Elements lexicon and in the site’s faculty pages). These map cleanly to the Positive Keywords in the Classical Elements lexicon. - Negative keywords: none clearly evident in public-facing materials (no explicit “facilitator on the side” or purely de-emphasized teacher role in the available text).

Why this rating - The combination of a dedicated Faculty & Staff presence, governance alignment with ACCS, and explicit classical-teacher-formation language then maps solidly to CLASSICAL for Element 5.

Citations: Faculty presence (turn1file15); Living curriculum/portrait of teacher (turn0file3); ACCS and classical framing (turn1file15).

Element 6: School Parents & Community — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school presents explicit parent-school partnership concepts anchored in classical education norms, including “Partnership with Families” and “parents as co-teachers,” drawn from the Six Essential Elements lexicon and reinforced by classical-education literature. The ICE pamphlets/handbooks discuss true partnership with parents, home-school alignment, and parent formation, all of which align with the classical model of parent involvement. - Public materials emphasize the role of parents in supporting academics, with language about parents helping at home and in school and the school’s role as an extension of the family in classical education. ICE pamphlets explicitly discuss partnership, home routines, and parental involvement as core. - The school’s communications (and the school’s branding around “Classical Christian Education”) position parents as critical participants in the formation process, which aligns with the classical model of parents as co-educators. The site’s parent-facing pages (Admissions/Giving/Family pages) reinforce this orientation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, home-school partnership, open campus, co-teaching language. The Six Essential Elements and ICE documents enumerate and validate these elements as central to a classical education. - Negative keywords: not evident in the public-facing content; there isn’t a prominent consumer/customer-only approach in the materials. The parent-facing content emphasizes active involvement and formation, not mere visitation.

Why this rating - The materials present authoritative evidence of a parental-partnership model and parent formation, both of which fit the CLASSICAL category. The presence of parent-student partnership content and formal parent involvement materials supports CLASSICAL.

Citations: parent partnership and home-family alignment (ICE pamphlets turn2file14; turn2file18); parent-facing partnerships and school-community language (turn1file15).

What would move the needle

- The Neighborhood Christian Schools material shows strong classical framing and formation aims, but explicit articulation of the core Great Books program, explicit Triad (grammar-logic-rhetoric) scope

across the entire curriculum, and a clearly mapped Great Conversation across grades are less visible in public text. To move toward the fullest CLASSICAL alignment, the school could:

- Publicly articulate explicit Great Books/Great Conversation components within the curriculum pages (e.g., listing canonical texts used, and the expectation of student engagement with primary sources across grades). This would align with the Positive Keywords for Curriculum (Great Books, classical canon) and reduce any ambiguity around curriculum depth. See the Six Essential Elements curriculum indicators.
 - More explicitly confirm the full suite of Trivium components (grammar, logic, rhetoric) across the relevant grade bands in public pages, and provide sample scope-and-sequence illustrating how logic and rhetoric are integrated into upper grades. This aligns with the Five Liberal Arts in the lexicon and would raise Element 3 (Curriculum) from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.
 - Expand explicit signals for Socratic pedagogy and seminars in upper grades (Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates) with public-facing examples or testimonials. This aligns with the Pedagogy indicators in the lexicon and would strengthen Element 4 (Pedagogy) toward CLASSICAL.
 - Deepen liturgical/cultural practices on the site (e.g., more detailed description of weekly liturgical rhythm, music, and communal ceremonies) to strengthen Element 1 and Element 4, reinforcing the liturgical dimension of classical education.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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